

# APA League Data Structure and Stats Explained

## APA Member vs. Alias: Understanding Player IDs

In the APA League system, each person is a **Member** with a unique global Member ID, but that person will have a separate **Alias ID** for each local league area. The alias represents the player's identity within a specific League (e.g. *Rio Grande Valley APA*) and is needed to retrieve their local stats. In the APA's data, a Member profile contains an array of `aliases` – each alias includes the league info, a **Member Number** (often the league's code plus the player's local number), and format coverage (8-Ball, 9-Ball, or both) <sup>1</sup> <sup>2</sup>. For example, a player Juan S. might have a Member ID and a separate Alias ID in league #785 (Rio Grande Valley), with formats `["EIGHT", "NINE"]` indicating he plays both 8-ball and 9-ball in that league <sup>1</sup>. The alias is used to fetch that player's league-specific stats (such as their win/loss record, skill level, and performance in each format).

*Member Number vs. IDs:* The **Member Number** you see (like #78501570) is the APA number combining the league code (785) and the player's local ID <sup>3</sup>. The site often uses Alias ID behind the scenes when viewing stats – this was the “alias thing” that can be confusing. In practice, to get detailed stats for a player, the APA website first looks up the alias ID for that member in the league, then retrieves stats using that alias ID. In summary, **Member ID** is global, while **Alias ID** + League identifies the player within a specific league.

## Common Player Stats Tracked by APA

APA leagues track a variety of stats for each player in each format. The core stats you'll see on team rosters and player profiles include:

- **Skill Level (SL):** The player's current handicap in that format – ranging from 2 up to 7 in 8-Ball, and 1 up to 9 in 9-Ball (higher is more skilled). For example, a SL7 in 8-ball is the highest skill level in that format, whereas a SL9 is top in 9-ball. The skill level influences the race (how many games or points needed) but also is just listed as a stat.
- **Matches Played** and **Matches Won:** How many matches the player has played and how many of those were wins. From this, a **Win %** is calculated. For instance, if a player has **Won/Played = 4/8**, their win percentage is 50%. The roster sheet displays this as, say, “4/8 50%” for Wins/Played and Win% <sup>4</sup>.
- **Points Per Match (PPM):** This is the average *team points* the player earned per match. APA uses a point system for each individual match (explained separately for 8-ball vs 9-ball below). PPM is essentially the player's total points earned divided by matches played. For example, in 8-ball a player who typically wins with 2-0 or 2-1 scores might have a PPM around 2.0 (since the max per 8-ball match is 3 points). In 9-ball, a player who often scores around 12 out of 20 points per match will have PPM ~12.00. On the roster, you might see a player with *PPM 1.00* in 8-ball (meaning on average 1 point per match out of 3) <sup>5</sup>, or *PPM 12.00* in 9-ball (12 out of 20) <sup>6</sup>.

- **PA (Points Average or Points Availability %):** This is the **percentage of available points** the player earned. It's essentially the same performance measure as PPM, but normalized to a percentage. PA is calculated as (Points earned) ÷ (Points available). In 8-ball, 3 points are available per match; in 9-ball, 20 points are available per match. APA's formula ties these together:  $PPM = PA \times (Max\ Points\ per\ match)$  <sup>7</sup>. So if an 8-ball player has a PA of 33.33%, that means they earned one-third of the points on the table on average – which corresponds to a PPM of 1.00 (since 33.33% of 3 points  $\approx$  1) <sup>5</sup>. In 9-ball, a PA of 60% corresponds to a PPM of 12.00 (60% of 20) <sup>6</sup>. The PA% allows comparison across formats – e.g. 60% in either format means the player consistently scored 60% of the points available in their matches. **Important:** PA and PPM carry the same information, and APA typically uses PA% for MVP rankings (since it ranks players identically to PPM) <sup>7</sup>.
- **Lifetime Statistics (CLA and Highest SL):** The APA system also tracks lifetime records. In the data, you'll see fields like `EightBallLifetimeStatistics` and `NineBallLifetimeStatistics` which include a number called **CLA** alongside a skill level <sup>8</sup>. The "CLA" in this context stands for **Career Lifetime Achievement** – specifically, it denotes the highest skill level that player has achieved in that format (their peak skill level). For example, if a player is currently SL5 in 8-ball but at one point had been a SL6, the lifetime stats might show `"CLA": 6` for 8-ball with current skillLevel 5. If a player has never exceeded their current SL, the CLA may match their SL or be zero if not enough data. For instance, one player's data shows EightBall CLA 5 with skillLevel 5, and NineBall CLA 4 with skillLevel 5 <sup>8</sup>, indicating their highest-ever 9-ball rank was 4 (even though they are a 5 now), perhaps due to recent improvement. Another player might have CLA 0 for 8-ball with skillLevel 6 <sup>9</sup>, implying they are a new 8-ball player (no "highest" rank established yet beyond the current). Essentially, **CLA = Highest SL ever attained** in that format (lifetime). This stat is useful for understanding a player's experience cap; APA sometimes displays it to show how far a player has progressed historically.

## APA 8-Ball: Scoring System and Stats

**Match Scoring in 8-Ball:** In APA 8-ball format, each individual match between two players is scored on a **3-point system** (often called the "3-0 scoring"). The winner of the match can earn 3 points or 2 points for their team, depending on how many games the opponent won, while the losing player's team earns 0 or 1 point. In a single 8-ball match: - If the winner shut out the opponent (opponent won 0 games), the score is **3-0** (3 points to winner's team, 0 to loser's). - If the match went hill-hill (opponent won 2 games in an extended race) or in most cases if the opponent won at least one game, the winner's team gets **2** and the loser's team gets **1** (a 2-1 split). *[Most APA 8-ball races are best of 3 (first to 2 wins) for lower skill levels, and up to best of 5 for higher skill, but the points awarded are still 3-0 for a shutout or 2-1 if the loser won at least one game].*

This means each 8-ball match is worth **3 total points** (split 3-0 or 2-1). A team match consists of 5 individual matches, so **15 points** are at stake in 8-ball before bonuses. The roster stats reflect this point system. For example, looking at an actual roster excerpt:

- *Julia J.* (SL5) had a record of 1 win out of 2 matches (50% win rate) and an average **PPM of 1.00** with **PA 33.33%** <sup>5</sup>. This indicates over those two matches, she earned on average 1 out of 3 possible points. Indeed, her total points were 2 out of 6 (which is 33.3%). That likely came from winning one match 2-1 (2 points) and losing another 0-3 (0 points), totaling 2 points in 2 matches = 1.0 PPM.

- Another player, *Denise G.* (SL4), might have a stat line like 2/3 matches won (66.7%), PPM 1.33, PA 44.44% <sup>10</sup>. If we interpret that: in 3 matches she earned 4 points out of 9 available (44.44%). For example, she could have won two matches 2-1 (2+2 points) and lost one 0-3 (0 points), totaling 4 points;  $4/9 = 44.44\%$  PA, and  $4/3 = 1.33$  PPM.

These examples show how 8-ball performance is quantified by points. **Win % alone doesn't tell the whole story** – two players might both be winning 50% of their matches, but one could be scoring more shutouts (3-0 wins) whereas another wins closer matches 2-1 or loses some 1-2. The PPM/PA captures that difference in dominance. In fact, APA's MVP ranking for 8-ball uses the PA% (points gained out of points available) to reward more dominant wins <sup>11</sup> <sup>12</sup>. A player who is 7-0 with mostly 3-0 shutouts can outrank a player who is 11-0 but with many 2-1 wins in terms of PPM/PA <sup>13</sup> – because the first player captured a higher percentage of points available.

**8-Ball Special Stats (Patches):** APA 8-ball matches also track certain special accomplishments: - **8-on-the-Break (8OB):** sinking the 8 ball on the break and winning instantly. In data, an 8OB is counted in a stat field often called `eightOnBreaks`. - **8-Ball Break and Run (8BR):** where you break, make at least one ball, and run the table without the opponent getting a turn. Tracked as `eightBallBreakAndRuns`. - **Mini-Slam:** If a player achieves **both** an 8OB and an 8BR in the same league night (within the same match or on the same night), it's called a "Mini-Slam." There may be a `miniSlams` counter for this (some APA areas award a separate patch for this feat <sup>14</sup> <sup>15</sup>). - **Rackless Night:** If your opponent never got to break against you (meaning you won the initial lag and then won every rack, so the other player "*never racked*"), you earn a Rackless patch. This is logged in data as `rackless` (count of rackless matches) <sup>16</sup> <sup>17</sup>. For instance, a rackless match implies you won all games you broke – a sign of a dominant performance.

These stats often appear in APA's session summary for players. In the JSON data for a player's alias, you might see something like:  
`"eightBallBreakAndRuns": 1, "eightOnBreaks": 0, "miniSlams": 0, "rackless": 1` for the session – meaning the player had one break-and-run and one rackless night (and no 8OB) so far. Such achievements are usually recognized with patches (as detailed in APA patch program guides <sup>18</sup> <sup>16</sup>).

## APA 9-Ball: Scoring System and Stats

**Match Scoring in 9-Ball:** APA 9-ball uses a points-per-ball scoring. Each ball pocketed is 1 point and the 9-ball is 2 points (so 10 points are available each rack). Instead of win/loss by games, players race to a **point total** (determined by skill level; e.g., SL1 needs 14 points, SL9 needs 75 points to win). However, for **team scoring**, APA assigns **20 points per match**. The 20 points are split between the two players based on the final score of their rack points. In general, if a player wins the match, they will get between 11 and 20 of the team points, and the loser gets the remainder, so that the two always sum to 20. A shutout in 9-ball (where the loser earned under 19 points) results in a **20-0** split. A closer match yields something like 16-4, 13-7, etc., depending on how many points the losing player managed to score. APA's score chart breaks this down by ranges – for example, a common breakdown is: if the losing player scored 0–19 points, the winner gets 20–0; if the loser scored 20–29, score is 19–1; 30–39 is 18–2; 40–49 is 17–3; 50–59 is 16–4; 60–69 is 15–5; 70–74 is 14–6; and if by some circumstance the loser nearly reaches the goal (e.g. loses with 75 or just a hair under in a hill-hill between high SLs), you'd see around 13–7 or 11–9 splits <sup>19</sup>. In essence, **the closer the match, the closer the 20 points are split**. (The APA scoresheet has a "Score of Match" table to convert ball points to the 20-point system.)

What this means for player stats: every 9-ball match yields some points for both players' teams. A player who wins decisively will earn more of the 20 (e.g. 18-2 or 20-0), whereas a narrow win might be 11-9. A player could even lose the match but still earn significant points (e.g. in a case where they lost but pocketed a lot of balls, their team might get 6 or 7 points despite the loss).

On the roster stat sheet, we see 9-ball PPM and PA reflecting this. For example: - *Chris G.* (SL7) has **1/1** matches won (100% win), with **PPM 12.00** and **PA 60.00%** <sup>6</sup>. That indicates in his one match, he earned 12 out of 20 points (likely a relatively close win like 12-8 or 13-7). 60% of points is 12/20. - *Katelynn L.* (SL6) might be **2/2** (won 2 of 2 matches) with **PPM 14.50** and **PA 72.50%** <sup>20</sup>. This suggests across two matches she averaged 14.5 points. Perhaps one match she won 20-0 and another ninth match with 9-11 (just an example) – averaging to 14.5. The PA 72.5% means she secured 72.5% of all points in her matches (dominant wins). - A player with a lower win rate can still have a decent PA. E.g., *Juan S.* (SL5) is listed as **1/3** (33% wins) but **PPM 6.33** and **PA 31.67%** <sup>21</sup>. He's only won one match out of three, but he's getting roughly 6.33 points per match on average (so even in losses, he must have scored some points). 31.67% of 20 means he earned about one-third of the points in his games – not great, but he's avoiding zeros.

One quirk of APA 9-ball: because matches end when someone hits their target, not all 20 points are always "claimed" through balls pocketed; the winner might reach their goal before 20 balls are scored. However, APA **awards the remaining points to the winner** to make the total 20. For instance, if a low skill player needed 31 points to win and they reach 31 while the opponent has 10, the remaining balls (up to 20 points worth) are given to the winner. This ensures every match adds to 20 for team standings. So from a data perspective, a winner's "nineBallPoints" (actual balls made) might be, say, 31, but their "match points earned" is 19 (if opponent had 10, yielding 19-1 split). This detail isn't directly visible in the roster stats, but it's why the PPM is a clean average out of 20.

**9-Ball Special Stats:** Similar to 8-ball, APA tracks special feats in 9-ball: - **9-on-the-Snap:** sinking the 9 on the break (analogous to 8OB). Tracked as `nineOnSnaps` in data. - **9-Ball Break and Run:** breaking and running the rack (sinking all balls 1-9 without the opponent shooting). Tracked as `nineBallBreakAndRuns`. - **9-Ball Mini-Slam:** earning both a 9-on-the-snap and a break-and-run in the same night. There may be a `miniSlams` count under NineBall as well. - **Skunk:** 9-ball terminology for a shutout 20-0 win (often earning a special patch for winning without the opponent scoring a single point). The data field `skunks` counts how many 20-0 victories a player has. For example, a `skunks: 1` would mean the player won a match 20-0 once (the opponent got "skunked").

These achievements also come with patches. For example, a "20-0 skunk" patch is relatively rare. Likewise, getting a 9-on-the-break or a 9-ball break-and-run in a match earns patches. The **patch program guide** explains these: a 9-on-the-Snap patch for drilling the 9 on the break, and a 9-ball B&R for a perfect run-out <sup>22</sup> <sup>23</sup>. A "9-ball Mini-Slam" patch may be awarded if you do both in one session night (depending on the local league's policy) <sup>24</sup>.

## Team Points and Bonus Points (Why Totals Don't Seem to Add Up)

When looking at team standings or weekly score totals, you might notice that the sum of match points doesn't equal the total points – this is where **bonus points** come in. APA leagues reward teams with bonus points for timely scorekeeping and dues payment. In our league (RGV APA), each week a team can earn up to **3 bonus points in 8-ball** and **15 bonus points in 9-ball** <sup>25</sup>. These are typically split for paperwork and

fees: - **8-Ball**: 1 point for turning in scoresheet (or submitting via app) on time & completed, 1 point for paying fees on time, and a 1-point extra bonus if both conditions are met – totaling 3 possible bonus points <sup>25</sup> . - **9-Ball**: 5 points for on-time scoresheet, 5 for fees, and 5 extra for doing both – totaling 15 possible <sup>25</sup> .

This explains, for example, why in the standings a team's weekly points might show as, say, "11 points" when only 9 came from matches. The additional 2 were bonus. A real example: after Week 4 in an 8-ball division, *Cue-ligans* had 34 points total and "9 pts – Week 4" <sup>26</sup> <sup>27</sup> . That 9 points in week 4 likely came from perhaps winning matches totaling 8 points plus 1 bonus, or 7 points plus 2 bonus, etc. In 9-ball, the totals are larger: e.g. a team might have "67 pts – Week 4" <sup>28</sup> <sup>29</sup> . Since 5 matches yield up to 100 points, a 67 means they got, for instance, ~52 points from matches and the full 15 bonus (52+15=67). Another team had "84 pts – Week 4" <sup>30</sup> – a very high score possibly due to a strong win (maybe ~69 out of 100 points from matches) plus 15 bonus to reach 84.

In short, **Team Total Points = Sum of match points won by the team + bonus points – any penalties**. Bonus points are why things sometimes "*don't seem to add up*" at first glance. If you add the individual match outcomes and get, say, 48, but the standings show 63, the missing 15 are likely the bonus (in 9-ball) <sup>31</sup> <sup>32</sup> . The bylaws confirm that the maximum bonus is 3 for 8-ball and 15 for 9-ball each week <sup>25</sup> . As long as a team meets its administrative tasks, those points are added, which can make a huge difference in rankings over a session.

Finally, note that forfeits also have preset point values (e.g. a forfeited 8-ball match = 2-0 win; a forfeited 9-ball match = 15-0 win in regular session) <sup>33</sup> <sup>34</sup> . These ensure teams get some points even if the opponent no-shows (and are one reason you might see odd totals like an exact 60 in 9-ball if multiple matches were forfeited).

By consolidating all the above information, we have a comprehensive view of **APA league data**: - Players are identified by **alias** within a league, which ties to their stats. - **General stats** like skill level, win %, and points (PPM/PA) measure performance, with PA/PPM providing an apples-to-apples metric across 8-ball and 9-ball <sup>7</sup> . - **Lifetime/alias stats** track highest skill levels achieved (and possibly other career info). - Format-specific nuances in scoring (3-point system vs 20-point system) explain how those points are earned. - Special feats (8OB, 8BR, 9OS, 9BR, etc.) are counted and celebrated, though they don't directly change points – they're for milestones and patches <sup>18</sup> <sup>16</sup> . - Team points include bonus awards, which reconcile any seeming discrepancies in totals <sup>25</sup> .

With this reference, any future question about APA league stats – be it "*Why did my team get X points this week?*" or "*How is MVP calculated?*" – can be answered by looking at these explanations. All the little "aliases and averages" quirks are now documented, so we won't have to rediscover them from scratch. Enjoy your league knowing exactly what all the numbers mean!

**Sources:** APA League data and player stats from RGV (Fall 2025) <sup>35</sup> <sup>6</sup> ; APA Official Team Manual & local bylaws <sup>25</sup> ; APA discussion on MVP stats <sup>7</sup> ; APA Patch Program guide for achievement definitions <sup>16</sup> <sup>23</sup> .

4 5 6 10 20 21 26 27 28 29 30 35 **APA Standings and more as of week 4.pdf**

file:///file-S6j3SfiN9kwAHACsahw7Pi

7 11 12 13 **How is APA 9 ball mvp calculated? | AzBilliards Forums**

<https://forums.azbilliards.com/threads/how-is-apa-9-ball-mvp-calculated.415406/>

14 15 16 17 18 22 23 24 **APA Patch Program – Comprehensive Guide.pdf**

file:///file-S6ELgZpFkzjCi9pBW3Du8T

19 **[PDF] 9-Ball Scoresheets - Tampa Bay APA Pool Leagues**

<https://tampabay.apaleagues.com/Uploads/tampabay/Website%20Forms/9Ball%20Blank%20Scoresheet.pdf>

25 **785\_bylaws\_2025.pdf**

file:///file-Db9h53QuMTd5fvhePeXkYv

31 32 **dump\_structured.json**

file:///file-UgirGhEkjkPcu1twgpToKV

33 34 **team-manual-english.pdf**

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